



Brand *Playbook.*

The rule book and the toolkit for IIMBx — the digital learning foundation of the Indian Institute of Management Bangalore. Written to be executed, not admired.

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CUSTODIAN	IIMBx Brand Team
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FOR	Leadership · Designers · Developers · Marketers · Vendors

What's inside *this playbook.*

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1.1 · THE PROMISE

THE BRAND, IN ONE SENTENCE

The same faculty who teach IIM Bangalore's flagship programmes will teach you. Live online, on-demand, and on the Bannerghatta campus when the programme calls for it.

That sentence is the entire brand. Everything else in this book is a consequence of it.

IIMBx is not edX. IIMBx is not Coursera. IIMBx is not a video library with a famous logo on top. The faculty who teach the country's most respected managers in residence at IIM Bangalore — they are the same faculty who teach the learner sitting at home in Pune at eight on a Tuesday evening. The same lectures. The same case studies. The same standard.

The three modes — live online, on-demand, and on campus — are not a hierarchy. Most of the learning lands as on-demand video, readings and assignments, because that is where the depth gets built. Live cohort sessions punctuate that work. Campus immersion at Bannerghatta exists where a programme genuinely benefits from being in a room together. None of the three is 'the real one'; the mix is the product.

1.2 · THE X IS THE BRAND

Most marks tell you *one thing*.

The IIMBx X tells you several, all at once, all true.

01

Generational.

Crimson dots are learners we teach today. Navy dots are alumni — the cohorts already taught, scattered across 190 countries. The X is what happens when one cohort hands itself to the next.

02

Relational.

Crimson dots are learners. Navy dots are faculty — the IIM-B professors who shape India's most respected managers. The X is the meeting. Without crimson, no one to teach. Without navy, no one to learn from.

03

Structural.

The X is a force multiplier. Cohorts, live sessions, campus immersion at Bannerghatta, faculty-led classrooms, alumni networks — the things that make IIMBx more than a video library.

04

Multiplication itself.

Whoever encounters the X is welcome to find their own truth in it. We do not pin the meaning down. The meaning is, in the end, multiplication.

Five principles. Every *decision answers to them.*

01 **Faculty first, technology second.**

Every feature, claim, and design decision answers one question: does this make the faculty's teaching more powerful, or less?

02 **Asynchronous by design, live where it earns its place.**

The product is overwhelmingly on-demand — that is where most of the depth is built. Live cohort sessions punctuate that work; they are not a substitute, and not the headline.

03 **Campus is real, not metaphor.**

When we say campus immersion, we mean the actual Bannerghatta campus, with the actual faculty, in actual rooms. We never borrow the word.

04 **Outcomes over enrolments.**

We measure ourselves on what learners do after they graduate — promotions, ventures, transitions — not on how many of them signed up.

05 **Bengaluru, India, world.**

We are rooted here. The world will come to us when our work earns the visit.

2.1 · THE HORIZONTAL LOCKUP

The primary mark.



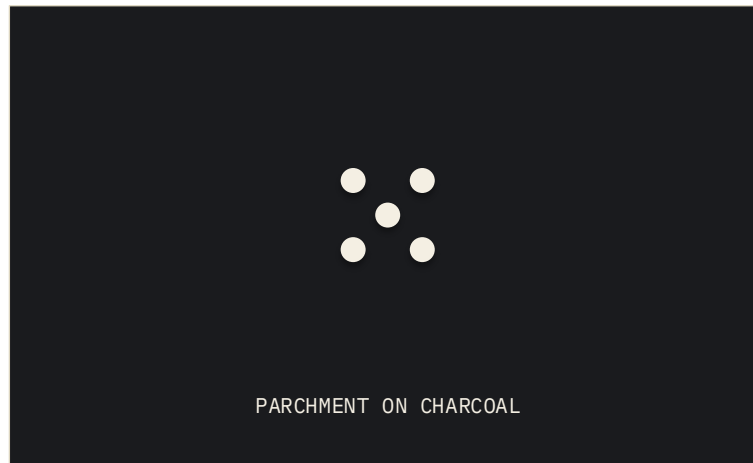
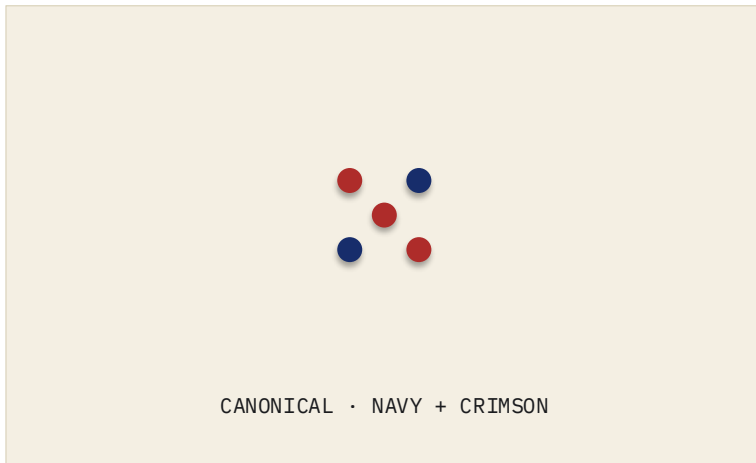
The lockup combines two equal halves: the IIM Bangalore institutional crest on the left, and the IIMBx wordmark on the right, separated by a single hairline rule. The rule is the brand's hinge — what you are reading is two things in balance, not one dominating the other.

Crest in **IIMB Crimson #AE2C2A**. Wordmark in **IIMBx Navy #172D6B**. The X uses both. These are sampled from the canonical artwork. Do not approximate them. When a vendor asks for the logo file, send the SVG. PNG is for preview only.

2.3 · THE X-ONLY MARK

For favicons, app icons, *and small spaces.*

Same five-dot geometry as the X embedded in the lockup — drawn at a different density. This is intentional.



Why the difference: The lockup X lives next to type and benefits from a denser construction. The X-only stands alone — dense dots collapse into mud at favicon scale or on embroidery. Same geometry, different density, calibrated to where the mark must live.

2.5 · REVERSE USAGE

Approved — but only *the canonical reverse.*

THE RULE

The lockup has two approved applications: full colour on white, and the canonical reverse (parchment + crimson on charcoal). No third treatment is licensed.

A clean reverse is the right answer when the surface is dark and a parchment plate would feel heavy. The reverse is canonical, not improvised — it is supplied as a separate artwork file, not generated on the fly with a CSS filter.

The parchment plate becomes the fallback for busy or photographic surfaces where neither full-colour-on-white nor reverse will read cleanly. Use it sparingly. Solid white-on-dark, monochrome navy, monochrome crimson — all unlicensed.

2.7 · CORRECT USE

Two applications. *Use one of the two.*



APPLICATION 01 · ON WHITE

The default. Certificates, formal academic correspondence, the LMS, the verification page, any product surface that is not editorial.



APPLICATION 02 · REVERSE

For dark surfaces. The same lockup, reversed for charcoal/navy/photographic backgrounds. Hero blocks, dark merch, social cards, dark-canvas promotional surfaces.

2.6 · MISUSE

Six ways to break *the brand. Avoid all.*

DON'T

Don't stretch.

Aspect ratio is fixed.

DON'T

Don't squish.

The hinge depends on proportion.

DON'T

Don't rotate.

It reads horizontally only.

DON'T

Don't crowd.

No taglines, sale stickers, or 'Enrol now' inside the clearspace.

DON'T

Don't improvise reverse.

Use only the canonical reverse (\$2.5) — supplied as artwork.

DON'T

Don't compete.

On busy surfaces, drop to the X-only mark or use the parchment plate.

Two registers. *One system.*

IIMBx wears two voices. The institutional voice is the voice we use when speaking on behalf of IIM Bangalore — ceremonial, formal, regulated. The sister-brand voice is the voice we use when IIMBx is being itself — marketing, social, product, learner-facing.

A learner who follows IIMBx through a year of marketing, enrolment, classes, and graduation should encounter the sister-brand voice 50% of the time, and the institutional voice on the certificate at the end. That ratio is the brand's centre of gravity.

3.1 · SURFACES BY VOICE

Where each register *actually lives.*

INSTITUTIONAL · CRIMSON + NAVY

Where IIMBx speaks for IIMB.

- Certificates of completion
- Convocation & graduation collateral
- Programme launch announcements (formal first reveal)
- Faculty appointments & academic letters
- Partnership memoranda with academic institutions
- Regulatory, accreditation & compliance filings
- Letterhead & official correspondence
- Annual reports & institutional research

SISTER-BRAND · MARIGOLD + CHARCOAL + PARCHMENT

Where IIMBx speaks for itself.

- Programme landing pages & marketing sites
- Brochures & lead-generation collateral
- Paid & organic social campaigns
- Email marketing & nurture sequences
- Onboarding & in-product UI (LMS, dashboard)
- Cohort communication after launch
- Event and merchandise collateral
- Faculty interviews, learner stories, blog posts

3.2 / 3.3 · THE PALETTES

Five colours that *do all the work.*

INSTITUTIONAL

IIMB Crimson

#AE2C2A

INHERITANCE

IIMBx Navy

#172D6B

AUTHORITY

Sampled from the canonical lockup. Combined, they occupy no more than 20% of any non-institutional surface. They flood backgrounds only on certificates, convocation announcements, formal launches, and academic letters.

SISTER-BRAND

Marigold / Burnt Honey

#C97138

SPARK · 10%

Charcoal

#1A1B1E

STRUCTURE · 15%

Parchment

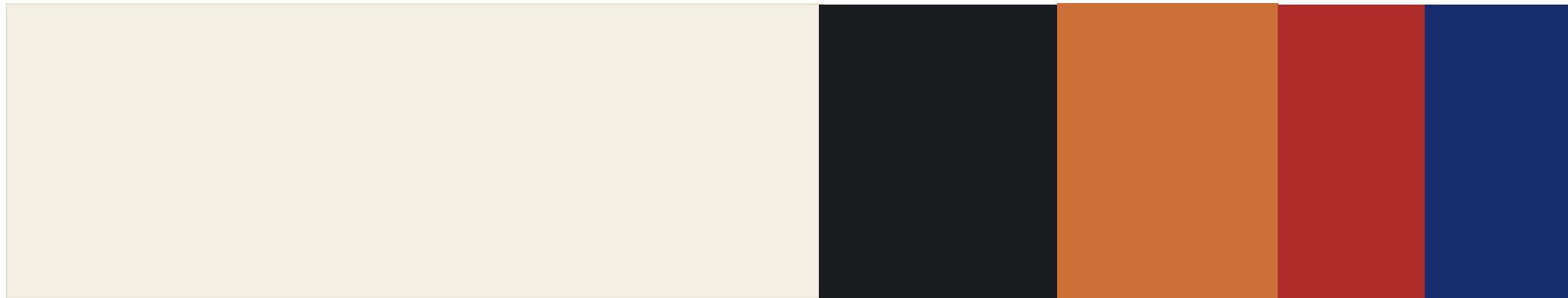
#F4EFE3

CANVAS · 70%

Most days, IIMBx wears parchment, with charcoal type and a marigold accent.

3.5 · THE 70 / 15 / 10 / 5 RULE

How the colours combine on *any* sister-brand surface.



50% CANVAS · PARCHMENT

15% CHARCOAL

15% MARIGOLD

20% INST.

On graduation day, the certificate inverts the ratio: it walks out in crimson and navy. The palette knows the difference.

Type that knows *when to whisper.*

DISPLAY

Tiempos Headline

Source Serif Pro / Source Serif 4 fallback

BODY

Inter

IBM Plex Sans fallback

SPECS

IBM Plex Mono

Hex codes · eyebrows · code

INDIC PAIRING — DEVANAGARI ONLY

The Sanskrit motto on the IIMB crest is part of the lockup and is never reset.

Bold like Nike. Warm *like Airbnb.*

SIX PRINCIPLES

- 01 **Speak in plain English.**
 - 02 **Make a claim or stay silent.**
 - 03 **Use strong verbs and concrete nouns.**
 - 04 **Verbs do the work. Adjectives are the seasoning, not the meal.**
 - 05 **Address one person.**
 - 06 **End on the strongest word.**
-

5.3 · BEFORE, AFTER

How the voice *corrects copy.*

BEFORE

Empower yourself with cutting-edge skills from world-class faculty in our flagship online programme leveraging Bangalore's premier B-school.

AFTER

The same faculty who teach inside IIM-B will teach you. From wherever you are.

BEFORE

Our state-of-the-art Learning Management System provides an immersive, gamified experience that maximises engagement and outcomes.

AFTER

You'll have a live class every Saturday. You'll have a cohort of fifty. You'll graduate with a certificate that means something.

BEFORE

Don't miss this once-in-a-lifetime opportunity! Register today before seats run out!

AFTER

Applications close 5 August. We take ninety students. Decide carefully.

Taking the call. *Choosing one line.*

RECOMMENDED · v3.1

**"The same faculty.
Wherever you
are."**

Eight words. Maps directly to the brand premise (§1.1).
Survives translation. Lives well in body, on a tee, on a
certificate.

ALTERNATE · IN POCKET

**"IIM Bangalore,
on your hours."**

Tighter. Names the institution explicitly. Slightly more
transactional. Use this if leadership prefers the
inheritance to be named.

USE SPARINGLY

**"Open. Knowledge.
Now."**

*Generic. Could belong to a podcast network. Doesn't
carry the inheritance. Live on existing surfaces until
reprint; no new use.*

The X is a design element, *not a logo.*

The merchandise system is built on one principle: the X is not an applied logo, it is a design element. Every approved treatment does something with the X — scales it, splits it, repeats it, embeds it, hides it, hand-draws it.

Three creative engines power the system: the X as constellation (alumni map), the X as multiplier (you × x), and the X as cultural object (the kolam). Recognising which engine a treatment uses is how the system stays coherent.

TREATMENT 02 · T-SHIRTS

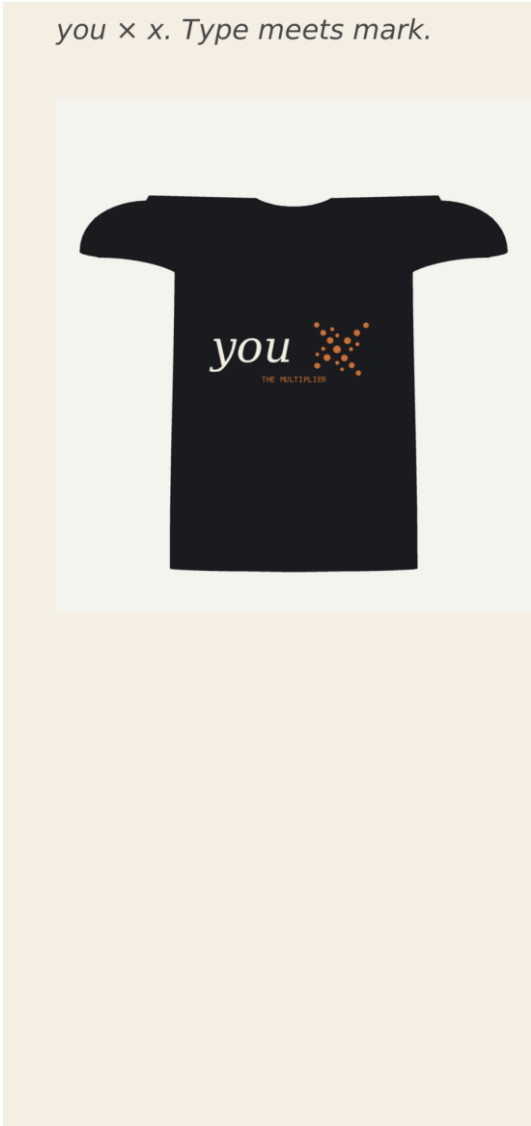
The Multiplier.

you × x. Type meets mark.

The X used as the literal multiplication sign. Reading left-to-right: 'you, multiplied by IIMBx.' Charcoal tee, parchment serif italic, marigold X. The tee that explains the brand's premise without writing a sentence.

VENDOR SPEC

STOCK	Combed cotton, 200gsm
COLOURWAY	Charcoal body, parchment + marigold print
LOGO SIZE	Composition width: 200mm
PLACEMENT	Centre chest, optical centre at 38% from top
PRINT METHOD	DTG (preferred) or 2-colour screen print



TREATMENT 03 · T-SHIRTS

The Constellation Back.

Alumni map, three cities pinned.

The X stretched horizon-to-horizon across the upper back. Three of the dots labelled with cities — BENGALURU, MUMBAI, DELHI — turning the alumni network into a constellation. The mark becomes a map.

VENDOR SPEC

STOCK	Combed cotton, 200gsm
COLOURWAY	Navy body, parchment + marigold print
LOGO SIZE	Constellation width: 280mm across upper back
PLACEMENT	Top of constellation 80mm below collar seam
PRINT METHOD	DTG (4-colour) or 3-pass screen

Alumni map, three cities pinned.



TREATMENT 04 · T-SHIRTS

The Kolam.

X drawn as if in rice flour.

The X rendered with the imperfect, hand-drawn quality of a kolam — slight position jitter, varying opacity, a few stray dots scattered around as if mid-drawing. Reads simultaneously as the IIMBx mark and as a traditional South Indian threshold pattern.

X drawn as if in rice flour.



VENDOR SPEC

STOCK	Combed cotton, 200gsm
COLOURWAY	Charcoal body, parchment print
LOGO SIZE	X mark width: 130mm
PLACEMENT	Centre chest, optical centre at 40% from top
PRINT METHOD	DTG with controlled imperfection — vendor must use the supplied kolam-style asset, not regenerate

TREATMENT 06 · T-SHIRTS

The Cohort Jersey.

Graduation merch.

Marigold body. Curved 'BANGALORE' in serif type arcing above a giant parchment X. 'COHORT 04 · 2026' in mono caps below. The energy of a sports jersey without literally being one. Cohort number changes per batch; the design template stays.

Graduation merch.



VENDOR SPEC

STOCK	Combed cotton, 220gsm — slightly heavier for graduation merch
COLOURWAY	Marigold body, parchment print
LOGO SIZE	X mark width: 220mm. 'BANGALORE' radius: 200mm.
PLACEMENT	Centred on chest. Arc text top of letters 80mm below collar.
PRINT METHOD	Screen print, 1-colour (parchment), or DTG for runs under 50

TREATMENT 01 · SIPPERS

The Wrap.

Vertical lockup centred. The classic.

The default sipper. Vertical lockup centred on the body, charcoal cap. For onboarding kits where the brand needs to be recognised before it's interpreted.

Vertical lockup centred.



VENDOR SPEC

BODY	Stainless steel double-walled, 600ml
COLOURWAY	Parchment body, charcoal cap
MARK SIZE	Vertical lockup height: 60mm
PLACEMENT	Centred on visible front face
METHOD	Single-pass laser engraving (preferred) or pad print

TREATMENT 02 · SIPPERS

The Neckband.

Marigold band, X mark below.

Charcoal body with a marigold ring around the upper body, small marigold X centred just below it. Reads like a watch face — the brand inscribed at the bezel. Premium and quiet.

Marigold band, X mark .



VENDOR SPEC

BODY	Stainless steel double-walled, 600ml
COLOURWAY	Charcoal body, marigold accent
MARK SIZE	X mark height: 22mm. Band height: 8mm.
PLACEMENT	Band 18mm below cap rim. X mark 12mm below band.
METHOD	2-pass laser engraving for X. Pad print for marigold band.

TREATMENT 03 · SIPPERS

The Pattern Wrap.

X tessellated as texture.

Marigold body covered in a small X repeat, parchment marks tiled in alternating rows. The bottle becomes the pattern. The most loud variant — for cohort merch and event swag.

X tessellated as texture.



VENDOR SPEC

BODY	Stainless steel double-walled, 600ml
COLOURWAY	Marigold body, parchment pattern
MARK SIZE	Individual X marks: 14mm. Spacing: 18mm horizontal, 24mm vertical.
PLACEMENT	Pattern wraps around the visible front face
METHOD	Sublimation print or full-wrap UV print

TREATMENT 04 · SIPPERS

The Cohort Etch.

Eucalyptus body, etched cohort details.

Eucalyptus-finished bottle. X etched centre-body in faded parchment tone. Below: 'PCHM · COHORT 04 · 2026' in mono caps. The graduation gift sipper. Programme code, cohort number, year — all change per batch.

VENDOR SPEC

BODY	Stainless steel, eucalyptus powder coat
COLOURWAY	Eucalyptus body, parchment-tone etch
MARK SIZE	X height: 32mm. Text height: 4mm.
PLACEMENT	Centred on visible front face
METHOD	Deep laser engraving — etch reveals base steel for that aged-bronze look

Eucalyptus body, etched cohort de



Eucalypt
faded pa
2026' in
Program
change p

VENDOR

BODY
Stainless

COLOURV
Eucalyptu

MARK SIZ
X height:

PLACEME
Centred c

METHOD
Deep las
aged-bron

TREATMENT 06 · SIPPERS

The Cohort Gauge.

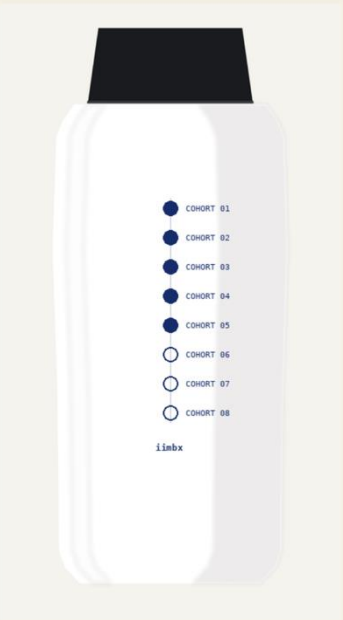
Vertical timeline.

White body. A vertical column of dots running up the bottle — five filled (past cohorts), three hollow (future). Each labelled COHORT 01 through COHORT 08 in mono. The sipper that turns the brand's history into ergonomic ornament. Updated each year.

VENDOR SPEC

BODY	Stainless steel double-walled, 600ml
COLOURWAY	Pure white body, navy print
MARK SIZE	Dot diameter: 6mm. Column height: 200mm.
PLACEMENT	Vertical column centred on front face
METHOD	Pad print (1-colour navy) — fill state updated each cohort year

Vertical timeline.



TREATMENT 02 · TOTE BAGS

The Split.

Half X on front, half on back.

Marigold tote with only the LEFT HALF of the X mark anchored to the right edge of the front. The other half is on the back. The mark only completes when both sides are seen. A small mono caption — 'see other side →' — anchors the joke. The conversation-starter tote.

VENDOR SPEC

STOCK	12oz heavyweight cotton canvas
DIMENSIONS	380mm × 420mm body
COLOURWAY	Marigold body, parchment + charcoal print
MARK SIZE	Half-X width: 160mm (per side)
PLACEMENT	Anchored to vertical centre line of bag, on inside edge
METHOD	2-colour screen print on each side. Vendor must register front and back precisely.

Half X on front, half on back.



TREATMENT 03 · TOTE BAGS

The Poster.

Oversized X with tagline.

Parchment tote. Massive canonical X dominating the front. Tagline 'open. knowledge. now.' in serif italic below. Small 'IIMBX' wordmark in marigold mono caps at the foot. The bag as a poster.

VENDOR SPEC

STOCK	12oz heavyweight cotton canvas
DIMENSIONS	380mm × 420mm body
COLOURWAY	Parchment body, navy + crimson + marigold print
MARK SIZE	X width: 240mm. Tagline height: 28pt.
PLACEMENT	X centred at upper third. Tagline directly below. Wordmark anchored to bottom margin.
METHOD	3-colour screen print or DTG

Oversized X with tagline.



Sister, *not subsidiary.*

IIMBx is the digital learning foundation of IIM Bangalore — a sister brand, not a subsidiary, not a sub-brand, not a product line. The relationship is structural and visible: the IIMB crest sits permanently inside the IIMBx lockup, and IIMBx never appears without it. This is not a mark of dependence. It is a mark of inheritance.

When IIMBx and IIMB co-publish, the IIMBx lockup leads, the IIMB seal sits in the footer or in a co-presentation panel. When IIMB publishes alone, no IIMBx mark is required. When IIMBx publishes alone, the inheritance is already inside the lockup.

With third-party partners, the IIMBx lockup leads on IIMBx-led work. Partner marks sit adjacent — separated by a vertical hinge rule that mirrors the lockup's own internal hinge, at equal optical weight. We do not lock partner marks into our lockup.

The whole brand, *on one page.*

If you have five minutes before a vendor call, read only this.

THE PREMISE	The same faculty who teach IIM-B's flagship programmes will teach you. Live online, on-demand, and on the Bannerghatta campus when the programme calls for it.
THE PROMISE	"The same faculty. Wherever you are." Eight words. Use it once per piece, never as a headline.
THE MARK	Horizontal lockup is the default. Two applications: full colour on white, or canonical reverse on charcoal. X-only for favicons and embroidery.
THE COLOURS	50% parchment · 15% charcoal · 15% marigold · 20% crimson + navy. Crimson + navy on certificates and formal academic surfaces. Marigold on everything else.
THE FONTS	Tiempos Headline (or Source Serif Pro) for display. Inter (or IBM Plex Sans) for body. IBM Plex Mono for hex codes and eyebrows.
THE VOICE	Bold like Nike. Warm like Airbnb. Strong verbs. Concrete nouns. Adjectives are the seasoning, not the meal. Address one person.
THE TWO VOICES	Institutional (crimson + navy): certificates, convocation, formal launches, regulatory filings. Sister-brand (marigold + charcoal + parchment): everything else.
WHEN IN DOUBT	Would a great teacher at IIMB say this in a classroom? If yes, ship. If no, rewrite.

That's the brand.

*Now go and make something
with it.*